Green-Leaf Buying Policy for Registered Outgrowers, 2026–27 Season

Pang Mok Khiao Tea Factory Co., Ltd. · Ref. PMK-LEAF-POL-04, version 4.1 · Approved by the Board on 22 September 2026 · Effective 1 October 2026

1. Purpose and scope

Pang Mok Khiao Tea Factory Co., Ltd. ("the Factory") processes oolong and green tea at Ban Pang Mok, Mae Chan district, Chiang Rai. Besides leaf from its own 140-rai estate, the Factory buys fresh green leaf from smallholder farms in nine hill villages of Mae Chan and Mae Fa Luang. Farmers who sell to the Factory must be listed on the Leaf Partner Register.

This policy sets out who may join the Leaf Partner Register, how leaf is delivered, graded, weighed and paid for, and how disagreements are settled. It applies to every registered outgrower and to all Factory staff who receive, grade or pay for outgrower leaf. Version 4.1 replaces version 3.2 of 15 February 2025.

2. Joining the Leaf Partner Register

A farmer may apply to join if all of the following apply:

- the farmer owns or holds a written lease of a tea plot of at least 1 rai and not more than 25 rai;
- the plot is within the Factory's collection area, which is shown on the map at the Outgrower Office;
- the farmer has attended the half-day Leaf Partner induction session, which is held on the first Saturday of every month at 09:00 in the Factory training room.

Applications are made in person at the Outgrower Office, beside the main gate, open Monday to Saturday from 08:00 to 16:30. The farmer brings a national ID card or highland resident card, proof of land use for the plot, and the first page of a savings account book in the farmer's own name. Each accepted farmer receives a Leaf Partner number in the format LP-0000 and a laminated farmer card, which must be shown at every delivery.

Registration is valid for one calendar year and must be renewed by 31 January. A farmer who does not renew by that date may still deliver leaf until 28 February, but payments are held until renewal is complete.

3. Collection points and delivery times

Leaf is received at six collection points: Ban Pang Mok (main gate), Ban Huai Kang, Ban Saen Chai, Ban Pha Daeng, Ban Mae Ku and Ban Lo Cha.

- Morning receiving: 07:00 to 11:00, Monday to Saturday.
- Afternoon receiving: 14:00 to 17:30, Monday to Saturday.
- Sundays and public holidays: Ban Pang Mok main gate only, 07:00 to 11:00.

Leaf must reach a collection point within 4 hours of plucking. It must be carried in clean, ventilated woven bags or bamboo baskets supplied or approved by the Factory. Plastic fertiliser sacks are not

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accepted, because they heat and bruise the leaf. A single bag may hold at most 18 kg of leaf; heavier bags are split at the collection point before weighing.

Note. During the first flush (1 March to 15 May) afternoon receiving at the village points is extended to 18:30, and an extra truck runs from Ban Lo Cha at 19:00.

4. Leaf standard and grading

Every delivery is graded at the collection point by a trained grader. The grader takes a random 200 g sample of shoots from the delivery and counts how many are fine plucks, meaning a bud with up to two tender leaves attached.

- Grade A: 70 % or more of the shoots in the sample are fine plucks.
- Grade B: 50 % to 69 % fine plucks.
- Grade C: less than 50 % fine plucks, or shoots with coarse stalks longer than 5 cm.

The grader rejects the whole delivery, and the Factory pays nothing for it, if the leaf is red, sour-smelling or warm to the touch in the centre of the bag; if it contains soil, stones, weeds or other foreign matter; if it was plucked within a no-pluck period under section 7; or if it arrives without a farmer card.

5. Weighing and wet-leaf deductions

Leaf is weighed on Factory scales in the farmer's presence, and the clerk issues a printed receipt showing the gross weight, deductions, net weight and grade. A fixed tare of 0.4 kg is taken off for each woven bag and 0.9 kg for each bamboo basket.

Leaf with water on its surface is reduced in weight after tare as follows:

- Dry leaf: no deduction.
- Lightly wet leaf (damp to the touch, no free water): 5 % deduction.
- Heavily wet leaf (water drips when a handful is squeezed): 12 % deduction.

Until 30 September 2026 the deduction for heavily wet leaf was 10 %. The new rate of 12 % applies to all leaf received from 1 October 2026.

6. Prices and payment

The base prices for the 2026–27 season, per kilogram of net weight, are:

- Grade A: 32 baht per kg (30 baht per kg until 30 September 2026).
- Grade B: 24 baht per kg.
- Grade C: 14 baht per kg.

A quality bonus of 2 baht per kg is added to all Grade A leaf delivered by a farmer in a payment period when at least 90 % of that farmer's net weight in the period is Grade A. The bonus does not apply to Grade B or C leaf.

Payment is made twice a month by bank transfer to the account registered under section 2. Leaf delivered from the 1st to the 15th of a month is paid on the 20th of the same month; leaf delivered from

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the 16th to the end of a month is paid on the 5th of the following month. If a payment day falls on a weekend or bank holiday, payment is made on the next working day. Amounts below 500 baht in a period may instead be collected in cash at the Outgrower Office on request.

7. Agrochemical use and no-pluck periods

Outgrowers may use only the crop-protection products and fertilisers listed in the Leaf Partner Handbook, 2026 edition. Every application must be written in the spraying log in the farmer card booklet, with the date, product and plot. Herbicides must not be used within 3 metres of tea bushes.

- No plucking for 14 days after an approved insecticide or fungicide is applied.
- No plucking for 7 days after a foliar fertiliser is applied.

The Factory sends random leaf samples to an independent laboratory for residue testing. If a sample fails, the farmer's Leaf Partner number is suspended for 60 days and the leaf from that delivery is destroyed without payment. A second failed test within 24 months leads to removal from the Register.

8. Responsibilities

- Collection-point clerks weigh the leaf, apply tare and wet-leaf deductions, and issue receipts.
- Graders sample and grade each delivery and decide on rejection at the collection point.
- The Head of Leaf Intake, Mr Athit Jabu, trains and supervises graders, checks the calibration of all scales every Monday, and carries out re-checks of disputed grades.
- The Outgrower Liaison Manager, Ms Duangporn Saelee, approves registrations and renewals, decides suspensions under section 7, and handles first-stage written appeals.
- The Finance Section makes payments and corrects payment errors within 10 working days of being notified.
- The Factory Manager, Mr Kittipong Thammawong, decides final appeals. His decision closes the matter within the Factory.

9. Disputes and appeals

A farmer who disagrees with a grade, a deduction or a rejection should follow these steps:

1. Before leaving the collection point, ask the grader for a re-check. The disputed leaf is set aside, not mixed with other deliveries, and a second 200 g sample is taken. At village points the re-check is done by the Head of Leaf Intake or his deputy by telephone video call.
2. If the farmer still disagrees, submit written appeal form PMK-F7 at the Outgrower Office within 3 working days of the delivery, attaching the receipt.
3. The Outgrower Liaison Manager replies in writing within 5 working days.
4. If the farmer is not satisfied with that reply, a final appeal may be lodged with the Factory Manager within 7 days of receiving it.

A grade cannot be changed once the leaf has been mixed with other deliveries, so a farmer who leaves without asking for a re-check may appeal only against weighing or payment errors.

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